

Game Makers — Week 1

Meet Scratch

Name: _____ My game's theme: _____

TODAY'S BIG IDEA

A program is a list of instructions, done **in order**, exactly as you wrote them.

Computers don't guess what you meant. That's not because they're stupid — it's because they're *very* obedient.

WORDS TO KNOW

Word	What it means
sprite	A character or object in your game
stage	The area where your game happens
backdrop	The picture behind everything
block	One instruction
script	A stack of blocks joined together
bug	Something in your code that doesn't do what you wanted

CLASS ACTIVITY — NAME DANCE

Make a sprite that says your name and then dances.

1. Pick a sprite you like.
2. Add `when green flag clicked`.
3. Add `say [your name] for 2 seconds`.
4. Make it dance: `move 50 steps`, `wait 0.5 seconds`, `move -50 steps`, `turn 15 degrees`.
5. Try adding `next costume` in between the moves.
6. Try `change size by 10`. Run it twice. What happens?

Stuck? Check that your blocks are actually joined to the `when green flag clicked` block. If there's a gap, nothing runs.

YOUR PROJECT — SKY CATCHER

Today you start the game you'll build all term.

- [] New project, named `Sky Catcher – [your name]`
- [] Pick your theme and write it at the top of this sheet
- [] Delete the cat

- [] Add a player sprite that fits your theme
 - [] Add a backdrop that fits your theme
 - [] `when green flag clicked` → `go to x: 0 y: -140`
 - [] Make it say something friendly when the game starts
 - [] **Save it**
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Homework

1. The four-line joke. Make a sprite tell a joke using four `say` blocks. Use waits so the punchline lands at the right moment. Bring it to Show & Tell next week!

2. Theme your player. Change your player's costume, colour or size so it really looks like your game's idea.

Bonus challenges

Only if you want to. Nobody has to do these.

1. Make a sprite draw a square. (Hint: four moves and four turns of 90 degrees.)
 2. Make two sprites have a conversation without talking over each other.
 3. Find the Sound blocks. Make your sprite play a sound.
 4. Make your sprite grow bigger and bigger, then snap back to normal.
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IF SOMETHING BREAKS

1. Say out loud: *what did I expect, and what did it actually do?*
 2. Change **one** thing and try again.
 3. Check you're looking at the right sprite.
 4. Ask a friend before you ask a grown-up.
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